Xray for Jira Cloud

Advanced Topics 12–21 — Jira Cloud Practical Steps

Beginner-friendly companion material for the numbered topics supplied by the learner.

Important: Xray Cloud menus and feature availability vary by plan, permissions, Jira layout, and product rollout. If a menu is missing, check the current official documentation and ask your Jira/Xray administrator.

Use this companion PDF while working in Jira. It gives a practical sequence, checks after each task, and troubleshooting notes. Replace sample issue keys with your own.

Before you start

- Confirm Xray is installed and you can access the correct project.
- Make sure your account has permission to create/edit issues and view Xray reports.
- Admin-only settings may need a Jira/Xray administrator.
- If a menu is absent, it may be renamed, disabled, unavailable in your plan, or restricted by permissions.

Practice scenario: requirement STORY-10 “A registered user can log in”; Test TEST-21 “Verify valid login”; defect BUG-31 “Login returns server error.” These are examples only.

12. Test Repository

Steps

- Open your Jira project and open Apps → Xray or the Xray Testing Board/navigation entry available in your site.
- Open Test Repository. If it is missing, check navigation and permissions.
- Create a top-level folder, e.g. Online Store.
- Create subfolders such as Authentication, Checkout, and Admin using the folder action available in your UI.
- Use the available add/move-to-folder action to place existing Tests in the correct folders.
- Select each folder and confirm the expected Tests appear. Open one Test to verify its issue key/details.

Confirm: selecting a folder shows its Tests. If create/move actions are missing, check permissions and the repository capabilities in your version.

> Use Test Repository for hierarchy; use Test Set for a flat reusable group of Tests.

13. Test coverage in Xray

13.1 Enabling coverage

- Ask an administrator to open Xray administration/settings.
- Find the requirement coverage feature or project coverage configuration.
- Enable coverage for the project if needed.
- Check issue-type mapping so Story/Task/custom requirement issue types are coverable where appropriate.
- Save and return to the project. If you lack admin access, request this configuration from the admin.

13.2 Mapping tests

- Open requirement STORY-10.
- Find the Tests/coverage section or supported issue-linking control.
- Add/link TEST-21 as the Test that verifies the requirement.
- Save if required and verify the link on the requirement.
- Open TEST-21 and confirm STORY-10 appears among linked requirements/issues.

13.3 Viewing report

- Open Apps → Xray → Reporting Center or the reporting area available in your site.
- If Reporting Center is absent, ask an admin whether it is enabled in Xray Features.
- Choose the requirement coverage/traceability report available.
- Select the correct project and scope/version filters.
- Generate the report and review requirements with linked Tests and coverage gaps.
- Open a sample requirement from the report to confirm the link is accurate.

Check: STORY-10 should show TEST-21. A requirement with no linked Test should be identified as a gap if it is included in the report scope.

14. Defect mapping in Xray

Steps to link a defect to a failed Test Run

- Open a Test Execution and select the relevant Test Run.
- Reproduce/inspect the failure and record the actual result.

- Set the Test Run to FAIL using the status control available.
- Find the Defects section or Create/Link Defect action.
- Choose Create Defect to make a new Bug, or Link Defect to select an existing Bug.
- Enter a clear summary, reproduction steps, expected/actual results, environment/build, and evidence.
- Save/create the Bug and verify that it is visible from the Test Run/execution details.
- Open the Bug and confirm the relationship is clear. After a fix, rerun the Test and record the new result.

Check: you can navigate from the failed Test Run to the Bug and understand what failed and where. If no defect action appears, check permissions and defect issue-type configuration.

15. Test environment

15.1 Enabling environment

- Open Xray settings/features or administration.
- Look for Test Environments and enable/configure them if supported and needed.
- Use consistent values, e.g. Staging - Chrome - Windows 11, Staging - Safari - macOS, Android - Build 2.4.
- If the option is missing, check plan/edition and ask an administrator.

15.2 Linking environments to executions

- Create or open a Test Execution.
- Find the Environment field/selector or equivalent environment section.
- Select/enter the correct environment and save.
- Reopen the execution and confirm the value persisted.
- If your setup supports environment details on Test Runs, verify them there too.

15.3 Using in reports

- Open a report that includes execution/Test Run data.
- Choose the correct execution/plan/project scope.
- Check whether an environment filter or environment column is supported.
- If it is absent, consult the report's supported fields or use a configurable document template.

Check: results from two environments should be distinguishable by the environment context recorded in the execution/run.

16. Custom fields in Xray

Steps (often administrator-assisted)

- Define the purpose, e.g. Automation Status with Manual/Automated/Planned options.
- Open Jira settings → Issues/Work items → Custom fields (wording varies by Jira UI).
- Create a field with a suitable type, such as select list, text, number, or date.
- Configure its context/options for the correct projects and issue types.
- Add the field to the appropriate issue screen or Xray-specific field configuration.
- Open a sample Test/Test Execution/Test Plan or supported Test Run view and confirm it appears.
- Enter a value, save, reopen, and verify it persists.
- Check JQL, dashboards, reports, and document templates if the field must be used there.

Jira issue fields and Xray Test Run fields may be configured in different places. Confirm the exact entity where you want the field to appear.

Check: field is visible, editable, saved, and available in the views/reports where required.

17. Importing test in Xray

17.1 Preparing test cases

- Prepare a supported CSV/spreadsheet or source file with clear Test summaries.
- Use one record per Test and prepare steps in the format expected by the importer.
- Check required fields, project, Test Type, duplicates, special characters, and supported relationship columns.
- Save a backup and test with two or three cases first.

17.2 Importing tests to Xray

- Open the Xray import flow or Jira import route that supports your source format.
- Choose the importer for Test definitions, not an automated-results importer unless you are importing results.
- Upload/select the file and map columns to Jira/Xray fields and test-step fields.
- Review preview, required fields, and validation warnings.
- Run the import and save the summary/created issue keys.

17.3 Confirming the import

- Open created Test issues from the result summary or search for them.
- Verify summaries, descriptions, Test Type, steps, expected results, custom fields, and links.
- Compare the source row count with the number of imported issues and inspect warnings.
- Confirm Tests appear in the Test list/repository and can be added to a Test Set/Plan/Execution.

Import menus vary by source format. Test definition import and automated execution-result import are separate workflows.

18. Test Execution List, Test Plan List, Test Run List, Tests List, Test Set List

List	How to access/check
Test Execution List	Open the Xray Testing Board/navigation and choose Test Executions, or use Jira issue search filtered to Test Execution. Check scope, progress, and linked plan/environment where available.
Test Plan List	Choose Test Plans in Xray navigation or search issue type Test Plan. Check release/scope and associated Tests/Executions.
Test Run List	Open a Test Execution and inspect individual Test Runs; use a dedicated Test Runs view if your site exposes one. Check status, actual result, evidence, environment, and defects.
Tests List	Open Xray Tests or search Jira for Test issue type. Check summary/type, metadata, requirements, and repository placement.
Test Set List	Open Xray Test Sets or search issue type Test Set. Check that the group contains the intended Tests.

Practical checks

- Filter each list to your project.
- Search for a known issue key to ensure it appears.
- Open rows to inspect full details; list columns may omit fields.
- If there is no separate Test Run list, access Test Runs through Test Executions.

19. Test coverage report

Test coverage

- Open Reporting Center and choose the coverage/requirement traceability report.
- Set the correct project and requirement scope.
- Generate the report and inspect covered requirements and gaps.
- Open sample links to verify they match Jira/Xray relationships.

Test Plan metrics

- Open a Test Plan or the Test Plan metrics report.
- Select the target plan and scope.
- Review status counts/progress supported by the report.
- Compare the metrics with associated Test Executions and investigate scope mismatches.

Traceability

- Open a traceability report.
- Choose the requirements, Tests, executions, and defects to include.
- Check that each requirement links to the appropriate Test and results/defects.
- Use the report to find missing relationships as well as failed Tests.

Xray documentation describes enabling Reporting Center through Xray feature settings. Menu labels can change; use the current documentation if the report cards are not visible.

20. Xray dashboard

20.1 Creating

- Open Jira Dashboards and choose Create dashboard or copy an existing one.
- Name it, e.g. QA Release Overview.
- Set the dashboard description and sharing permissions.

20.2 Adding gadgets

- Choose Add gadget.
- Search for Xray or relevant reporting gadgets available in your site.
- Add a gadget and configure its project/filter/plan/execution scope.
- Add only metrics that answer a question, such as execution progress, coverage gaps, or plan metrics.
- Arrange gadgets and verify that they show the intended scope.

20.3 Publishing

- Open dashboard settings/sharing/permissions.
- Share with the intended users or groups under your organization's policy.
- Ask a permitted viewer to open it and verify access.
- Confirm viewers can also access the underlying Jira/Xray data.

If no Xray gadget is listed, use Reporting Center reports and check with your administrator whether the desired gadget/app is installed.

21. Document Generator in Xray

21.1 Setting up template

- Open Apps → Xray → Reporting Center, if available.
- Choose Document Generator or open Xray global settings → Document Generator templates, depending on your site.
- If template settings are hidden, request the required admin permission.
- Select an existing template or create/customize one in the supported format.
- Check the template's issue types, link types, field names, and variables.
- Save and test it on a small known set of Test issues.

21.2 Generate documents

- Open the supported issue, issue search results, or Xray screen that defines the source scope.
- Choose Document Generator/export.
- Select template, output format (DOCX/PDF or other supported format), and file name/options.
- Generate the report and download it from the resulting dialog/screen.

21.3 Viewing document reports

- Open the downloaded document.
- Check issue keys, Test steps, requirements, Preconditions, Test Sets/Plans, execution results, and dates expected from the template.
- If fields are blank, check template variables, permissions, source selection, and template assumptions.
- Record generation date and scope when sharing because the document is a snapshot.

Some Jira sites use Xporter, a separate app with its own templates and export workflow. Confirm whether your site has Xray Document Generator, Xporter, or both.

Final practice checklist

- Create a repository folder structure and place Tests in it.
- Link a Test to a requirement and view coverage.
- Fail a sample Test Run and link a Bug.
- Record an environment on an execution.
- Create or configure one custom field.
- Import a small test file and validate the results.
- Open the five lists or their equivalent navigation/search views.
- Generate coverage/traceability and Test Plan metrics reports.
- Create a dashboard, add gadgets, and share it with a permitted viewer.
- Generate a document from a template and validate the output.

Official references

- Xray Cloud documentation
- Reporting Center
- Xporter Test Report template
- Repository, coverage, plans, executions, and reporting guidance